

Day 4 : Connecting and Testing Peripheral Theory

Task 1 : Connect a USB webcam to your computer, install any required drivers, and verify that the webcam works by opening the default camera app and capturing a photo.

Connecting and Testing a USB Webcam

Steps:

1. Connect the **USB webcam** to an available USB port on the computer.
2. Wait for Windows to detect the webcam. If required, allow Windows to automatically install the necessary **drivers**.
3. Open **Device Manager** and check under **Cameras** or **Imaging devices** to confirm that the webcam is detected.
4. Open the **Camera** app from the Windows Start menu.
5. If the webcam is detected, select it as the camera source if necessary.
6. Check the live video preview to make sure the camera is working correctly.
7. Click the **Capture/Photo** button to take a test photo.
8. Check the captured photo to confirm that the webcam is working properly.

Result

The USB webcam was successfully connected and detected by the computer. The Camera app displayed the webcam's live video, and a test photo was captured successfully.

Task 2 : Set up a local printer (USB or network), install the correct driver, and print a test page to confirm successful installation.

Setting Up and Testing a Local Printer

Steps:

1. Connect the printer to the computer using a **USB cable** or connect it to the same network as the computer.
2. Turn on the printer and make sure it has **paper and ink/toner**.
3. Open **Settings → Devices → Printers & scanners**.
4. Click **Add a printer or scanner** and wait for Windows to detect the printer.
5. Select the correct printer and complete the installation.
6. If Windows does not automatically install the driver, download and install the **correct printer driver** from the manufacturer's website.
7. After installation, select the printer and open **Manage → Printer properties**.
8. Click **Print Test Page**.
9. Check the printed page for clear text and images.

Result

The printer was successfully connected and the correct driver was installed. A **test page was printed successfully**, confirming that the printer is properly installed and ready to use.

Task 3 : Simulate a connectivity issue by unplugging the printer's USB cable, then use Windows Device Manager to identify and resolve the 'printer not detected' problem.

Troubleshooting a Printer Not Detected Issue

Steps:

1. First, turn off the printer and **unplug its USB cable** from the computer.
2. Open **Device Manager** by right-clicking the **Start** button and selecting **Device Manager**.
3. Check sections such as **Printers**, **Print queues**, or **Universal Serial Bus controllers** for the printer.
4. Look for a **yellow warning icon** or any error symbol that may indicate a driver or hardware problem.
5. Reconnect the printer's USB cable and turn the printer on.
6. In Device Manager, click **Action → Scan for hardware changes**. Windows will search for the newly connected printer.
7. Check whether the printer appears again without an error icon.
8. If a driver problem is shown, right-click the printer and select **Update driver**, then follow the instructions.
9. Finally, open **Settings → Devices → Printers & scanners** and check that the printer is detected and available.

Result

After reconnecting the USB cable and using **Scan for hardware changes**, Windows detected the printer again. The printer was then available for use.

Task 4 : A user reports that their webcam video is not displaying in Zoom, but it works in the default camera app. Troubleshoot and resolve the issue so the webcam works in both applications.

Troubleshooting Webcam Not Displaying in Zoom

Steps:

1. First, open the **Camera** app and verify that the webcam is working. If the video appears normally, the webcam hardware is working correctly.
2. Close the Camera app and any other applications such as **Microsoft Teams, Skype, or browser tabs** that may be using the webcam.
3. Open **Zoom → Settings → Video** and check the **Camera** option. Select the correct webcam from the available camera list.
4. Check Windows camera permissions by going to **Settings → Privacy → Camera**. Make sure **Allow apps to access your camera** is turned ON.
5. Make sure **Allow desktop apps to access your camera** is also enabled, because Zoom is a desktop application.
6. Restart Zoom after changing the permissions and test the webcam using **Zoom's video preview**.
7. If the webcam still does not work, restart the computer and open Zoom again. Check the camera settings once more.

Result

The webcam was working correctly in the Camera app, so the problem was related to **Zoom permissions or another application using the camera**. After closing other camera applications, enabling the required permissions, and selecting the correct webcam in Zoom, the video displayed successfully.